

About Pune

Pune, one of the largest urban agglomerations of India, is located in the Western Indian State of Maharashtra. The city is one of the biggest industrial towns in India and an important educational, industrial, and cultural centre. Pune hosts several universities, well-known institutions, and research organisations. The city also houses a large number of industries in the field of Information and Communication Technology (ICT), Automobile, Electrical, Electronics, Forging, Foundries and other engineering Industries. More than one hundred thousand skilled engineering professionals are working in and around the city. The strength of students studying in various disciplines in the city exceeds two hundred thousand.

More information about Pune can be found at:

<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pune>

<https://www.ixigo.com/travel-guide/pune>

<http://travel.india.com/pune/>

<http://www.maharashtratourism.gov.in/destination/pune-hub>

Places to visit in Pune

World Peace Dome



World Peace Dome, World Peace Prayer Hall and Library stand tall at 263 feet. It has a diameter of 160 feet. The height of the dome is 96 feet, whereas the height of the total structure from the ground to the apex is 263 feet. The inside sitting area is spread over an area of 20,000 sq. feet and the total seating capacity is 3000. The Library spreads across 62,250 sq. feet. This architectural wonder which was completed in 2018, was accomplished through 15 years of perseverance, dedication and hard work of over ten thousand people, comprising engineers, workers and artists from various communities.

Pune University



Pune's oldest education institute is the Pune University (now, Savitribai Phule Pune University) formed in 1948. The university has many affiliated education institutes and colleges from all parts of Maharashtra -- research institutes such as the National Chemical Laboratories, Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (CDAC), Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics, National Institute of Virology (NIV) are just to name a few. The IUCAA, one of the pioneering institutes for research in astronomy, is located in the lush green environment of Pune University and is headed by a world-renowned mathematician, Dr Jayant Narlikar. Pune University is located on 400 acres of sprawling grounds with quiet roads and small open canteens towards the city limits. It was once the official residence of the Governor of Mumbai during the monsoons, the Pune University is now a stately mansion at Ganeshkhind. A large building in the Italian Gothic style, built with local grey trap rock, it has a square tower 40 m high and well-maintained lawns. One can spend a pleasant evening here.

Shaniwar Wada



Built-in 1736, Shaniwar Wada was once the palace of the Peshwa rulers. This historic seven-storied palace was built by Bajirao Peshwa I. During his days, it became the seat of political power and achieved tremendous importance. To this date, Shaniwar Wada has been the city's main landmark. Within easy reach from all parts of the city, Shaniwar Wada was mysteriously destroyed in a fire in 1827. Mysterious fires continued to raze down portions of Shaniwar Wada in the early 19th century, and the entire palace --barring its Mirror Hall was burnt in the fire that broke out for about a fortnight. What now remains of this once palatial Wada are only the plinths, the fortification walls with five gateways, and nine bastions that enclosed the whole complex, the elaborate foundations of the original palace and the nagarkhana with its fine wooden pillars and lattice work. One enters the palace through sturdy doors designed to dissuade enemy attacks. This palace is located in the narrow winding old part of the city. The palace is open from 8 am to 6.30 pm. This site is covered in the Pune city tour.

Shinde Chhatri



Architecturally amongst the best, just about a couple of km from the Pune racecourse is the memorial of the great Maratha nobleman Mahadji Shinde. You can see the warrior's painted silver likeness, swathed in a flame-coloured turban and elaborate shawl. At his feet are the original prayer vessels, used to propitiate the family deity each morning. A sign asks you not to open an umbrella within the Chhatri's precincts, as it would be an insult to the warrior's memory.

Raja Dinkar Kelkar Museum



A must-see, this quaint building houses a fascinating collection of Indian artefacts collected by the late Shri Dinkar Kelkar. The 36 sections of the museum are used to display a wealth of antiques, carved palace doors, pottery, 17th-century miniatures, a priceless collection of nutcrackers, lamps, musical items, hookah pipes, hair drying combs and other such items from the Mughal and Maratha period. This collection was donated to the government of Maharashtra by Shree Dinkar Kelkar and is only displayed by rotation, giving you another excuse to return to Pune. The museum is open from 8.30 pm to 5.30 pm daily. The museum is covered in the Pune city tour.

Pataleshwar Cave Temples



Hidden in the heart of the city in the Shivajinagar area is this 8th-century rock-cut temple. Still in use, this temple, similar to the Caves at Ellora, has been painstakingly hewn from a single rock and includes massive pillars, a Shiva shrine and a Nandi bull.

Tribal Museum



The Tribal Museum documents the cultures of Maharashtrian communities, particularly those from the Sahyadri and Gondwana regions. It is open during weekdays from 10 am to 5 pm.

Gandhi National Memorial / Aga Khan Palace



The gracious buildings with salons and suites that you see standing amidst well-laid-out gardens are more than just a palace. It is a historical landmark. It was donated to India by the Aga Khan IV in 1969. During the 1942 Quit India Movement, Mahatma Gandhi was imprisoned here. On the grounds are the remains (samadhi) of Kasturba Gandhi, Mahatma Gandhi's wife, who died here while in internment. The memorial is open from 9 am to 5.45 pm. The city tour makes a stop here.

Vishrambaug Wada



This is a three-storied mansion, known for its beautiful entrance and balcony with carved woodwork typical of the Peshwa period. The 260 ft long and 815 ft broad Teen-Chowki Wada was built by the last Peshwa, Bajirao II as his residence for Rs. 2 lakhs. The Wada's eye-catching wooden facade is memorable in its beauty and has beautiful columns carved in the Suru form. On 31 October 1880, a surprise fire engulfed the Wada ravaging the entire structure. Vishrambaug Wada was restored to its somewhat original appearance by public subscriptions and municipal contributions. For many years till 1958, it was to serve as the offices of the Poona Corporation. Today it houses assorted offices, a strange fate for what was once a king's abode.

Saras Baug



Evenings are best for a stroll through this beautiful garden that houses the famous Ganesh Temple on the top of a small hillock in the centre. The temple was formerly surrounded by a lake, which has been fully reclaimed in the form of an open park, now a popular public place in Pune.

Parvati Hill



This famous landmark is located on the southern end of the city. A climb of 108 wide stone steps rewards you with a beautiful round view of the city and an invigorating draught of cool, fresh air. It also takes you to the group of four temples of Shiva, Ganesh, Vishnu and Kartikeya.

The Parvati Temple used to be the private shrine of the Peshwa rulers. Also take a look at the Parvati Museum, which houses replicas of ancient paintings, old manuscripts, and more.

Katraj Snake Park



Started in 1986 with the help of the Pune Municipal Corporation, the Katraj Snake Park is situated on the Pune-Satara Highway near the Bharati Vidyapeeth Campus. The straight road emanating from Swargate takes you to the desired destination. The park today has a collection of wonderful reptiles, birds, a baby leopard, crocodiles and others. The prize collection is of course the six-year-old, nine-foot-long King Cobra.